

AMax Firmware Update — Quick Guide (gant)

How to make delila-rs (the DAQ + Operator UI) follow a new AMax firmware register map. **Everything runs locally on this machine — no git commit / git push is required.** You edit/drop in a `RegisterFile.json`, run one script, restart the DAQ, and you're done.

Maintainers who want to share the result with other machines handle that separately. As an AMax FW developer you only need the steps below.

1. What the one command does

```
RegisterFile.json
├── amax_codegen    (register addresses auto-derived – no flags to guess)
│   └── src/config/amax_generated.rs                (AMaxChannelConfig
struct)
│       └── src/reader/caen/amax_registers_generated.rs    (REG_*,
BROADCAST_BASE, merge fn)
│           └── web/operator-ui/src/app/models/amax-generated.ts (UI types + param
defs + tabs)
│               ├── cargo fmt → cargo build → ng build
│               └── web/operator-ui/dist/                (the UI bundle
that is served)
```

`PAGE_BASE` / `PAGE_STRIDE` / `BROADCAST_BASE` are all derived from `RegisterFile.json` automatically. You never hand-pick them, and you never edit `handle.rs`.

2. Prerequisites (already set up on gant)

Tool	Notes
cargo	source ~/.cargo/env
node + npm	Node 22 LTS in ~/.local/node, on PATH. web/operator-ui/node_modules already installed.
Input	RegisterFile.json from the FW build
UI metadata	tools/amax_viewer/fw_params.json (label / category / type / bit width / default per register)

3. Quick start (normal case — addresses moved)

```
cd /media/raid1/delila-rs
source ~/.cargo/env
```

```
# 1. Put the new RegisterFile.json somewhere in the repo (convention:
FW/<date>/)
#   e.g. FW/20260701/RegisterFile_1july.json

# 2. One command
scripts/update_amax_fw.sh FW/20260701/RegisterFile_1july.json
```

You'll see a summary:

```
amax_codegen layout: PAGE_BASE=0x... (auto), PAGE_STRIDE=0x... (auto),
BROADCAST_BASE=0x... (auto), canonical=per-channel ch0
amax_codegen: register set unchanged (29 registers)
```

If it says **register set unchanged**, you're done with regeneration — go to **§6 Apply it (restart the DAQ)**.

The script prints a **git add ...** hint at the very end. **You can ignore it** on gant — your changes are already built and stay local.

Options

- **--no-ui** — skip the Angular build (Rust-only, faster)
- **--with-viewer** — also regenerate amax_viewer's **register_defs.json** (best-effort)
- **--help** — usage

4. When the register set changes

Added / removed registers

The summary tells you:

```
amax_codegen: register set changed – 2 added, 0 removed
+ NEW_REG_A, NEW_REG_B
warning: 2 register(s) in RegisterFile.json have no entry in fw_params.json
(skipped):
- NEW_REG_A
- NEW_REG_B
```

no entry in fw_params.json (skipped) means **that register is NOT exposed** (neither typed config nor UI). To expose it, add one line to **tools/amax_viewer/fw_params.json** under **params**:

```
"NEW_REG_A": { "bits": 16, "default": 100, "label": "New Reg A",
"category": "energy", "type": "number", "unit": "ns" }
```

Field	Meaning
<code>bits</code>	data bit width (<code>max = 2^bits - 1</code> computed automatically)
<code>default</code>	initial value
<code>label</code>	UI display name
<code>category</code>	UI tab: <code>input</code> / <code>trigger</code> / <code>energy</code> / <code>amax</code> , or a new name (see below)
<code>type</code>	<code>number</code> , or <code>enum</code> with <code>options: [...]</code>
<code>unit</code>	optional display unit

Then run the same command again. Removing a register needs no metadata edit — codegen shrinks the struct and the merge function together (no `handle.rs` edit).

New category (new tab)

Just use a `category` name that doesn't exist yet (e.g. `debug`). The codegen emits the new param array and category map, and the Operator UI shows a **new tab automatically** (Settings and Tune Up), no TypeScript editing.

5. Safety guard

If the broadcast page and the per-channel page disagree on a register's in-page offset, codegen **aborts** (`... layout mismatch ... codegen aborted`). Writing a wrong AMax register address can corrupt the firmware, so this is intentional — fix the RegisterFile, or use an explicit override flag (`--page-base 0x... --broadcast-base 0x... --prefer-per-channel false`, decimal or `0x` hex). Overrides are rarely needed.

6. Apply it (restart the DAQ)

The new code lives in the rebuilt binaries; the running DAQ must be restarted to pick them up. Restart **only when no run is active** (Idle / Configured is fine — no data is lost).

```
cd /media/raid1/delila-rs
source ~/.cargo/env

scripts/stop_daq.sh
scripts/start_daq.sh config/config_amax_56_2Digitizer.toml
```

MongoDB: the operator reads its connection from the config's `[operator.mongodb]` section (`--mongodb-uri` / `--mongodb-database` CLI flags are only overrides), so run history is saved **whether or not** you pass `--no-mongo`. Omitting `--no-mongo` additionally makes the script verify the persistent `delila_mongo` Docker container is up (it pings it, does not restart it) — slightly more robust, so prefer omitting it.

Check that everything is back: <http://localhost:9090/api/status> should show all components **Idle** and **online**, or open the Swagger UI at <http://localhost:9090/swagger-ui/>.

7. Verify on hardware

The new register-write logic takes effect on the **next Configure** after the hardware is powered on.

1. Power on the digitizer / NIM crate. (While it's off, the reader logs **CAEN error -4: DEVICE NOT FOUND** and retries — that's normal; it reconnects automatically once power is on.)
2. Configure via the Operator UI / REST (do not send raw ZMQ commands).
3. In the reader log, sanity-check the applied addresses (**BROADCAST_BASE**, per-channel addresses) match what you expect.
4. After Start, confirm the ADC spectrum / waveform looks right. If the FW misbehaves, power-cycle the digitizer and re-Configure.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause / fix
... layout mismatch ... codegen aborted	broadcast vs per-channel offsets disagree. Check the RegisterFile; use override flags only if intentional.
no entry in fw_params.json (skipped)	register not exposed. Add it to fw_params.json and rerun (§4).
New register/tab not in the UI	fw_params.json entry missing, or the UI wasn't rebuilt — rerun without --no-ui .
npm not found warning	Node not on PATH . On gant: source ~/.profile (or open a new shell), then rerun.
reader CAEN error -4: DEVICE NOT FOUND	digitizer / crate powered off. Power on; the reader reconnects. Not a build problem.
Build error struct AMaxChannelConfig has no field ...	generated files out of sync with handle.rs. Rerun scripts/update_amax_fw.sh — it regenerates both consistently.
FW unresponsive after Configure	possible bad-address write; power-cycle the digitizer and re-Configure with correctly generated bindings.

9. How it works (reference)

- **Address auto-derivation** (**src/bin/amax_codegen.rs**, **derive_layout**): registers are grouped by **channel_index()** into broadcast / ch0 / chN. **PAGE_BASE** = min ch0 address (or broadcast if no per-channel pages), **PAGE_STRIDE** = **addr(ch1) - addr(ch0)**, **BROADCAST_BASE** = min broadcast address. Registers shared by both pages must keep an identical in-page offset (the safety guard, §5).

- **handle.rs is FW-agnostic:** `apply_amax_channel_config` calls the generated `channel_register_byte_addr / broadcast_register_byte_addr / channel_writes / merge_amax_channel_config` and never names register fields directly, so it doesn't change when registers are added or removed.
- **UI tabs are data-driven:** `channel-params.ts` iterates the generated `AMAX_PARAMS_BY_CATEGORY`, so a new category becomes a tab automatically.